# City of Philadelphia

## Strategic IT Landscape and Market Analysis Report

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# 1. Executive Summary & Macro Landscape

The City of Philadelphia is currently navigating a profound and highly accelerated transitional period characterized by a shift in executive leadership, an ambitious technological modernization agenda, and the complex expiration of federal pandemic-era funding. Under the administration of Mayor Cherelle L. Parker—who serves as Philadelphia's 100th mayor and the first woman to hold the office in the city's 341-year history—the municipality is executing a sweeping administrative vision branded as the "One Philly" and subsequent "One Philly 2.0" agenda. This comprehensive agenda is fundamentally reliant on advanced technological enablement to achieve its core objectives, presenting a lucrative, highly strategic, and expansive landscape for enterprise technology partners equipped to handle massive public sector deployments.

Mayor Parker's administration has aggressively pivoted away from the municipal status quo, advancing a historic proposed $7 billion operating budget for Fiscal Year 2027 (FY27).[1] This budget represents a significant year-over-year financial expansion, backed by a proposed Five-Year Plan that adds $641.7 million in new operating investments through FY31.[2] The macro-economic climate in Philadelphia is defined by a delicate and highly scrutinized fiscal balancing act. The city must manage the complete exhaustion of its $1.4 billion in American Rescue Plan Act (ARPA) funds by the end of calendar year 2024, a reality that removes a massive federal fiscal backstop that previously subsidized various municipal operations. Simultaneously, the administration is instituting aggressive local tax reforms to fund these new investments, including a 2% increase to the Hotel Tax, a Retail Delivery Tax to fund road improvements (the "Pothole Posse"), and a $0.20 per ride tax on rideshares.[3][4] Consequently, the city's leadership is demanding that all net-new IT investments deliver immediate, measurable operational efficiencies and structural cost reductions to offset impending fiscal tightening across the general fund.

For Dell Technologies, the City of Philadelphia represents a rapidly expanding market with a remarkably high propensity for core infrastructure modernization, edge computing deployment, and enterprise-wide workforce transformation. The city's technology apparatus is actively emerging from a prolonged period of high technical debt, highlighted by the recent removal of thousands of outdated servers and legacy hardware. Today, the municipality is heavily capitalized to execute specialized, high-compute projects across public safety, health and human services, and civic infrastructure. The administration's focus on data-driven accountability, represented by platforms like "Philly Stat 360," requires a resilient, highly available, and secure technological foundation capable of processing vast amounts of structured and unstructured data.

The top core administrative goals for the current fiscal year are rigidly structured around specific operational pillars, each carrying distinct and heavily funded technology mandates that require immediate vendor alignment:

**Public Safety and the Prevention, Intervention, and Enforcement (P.I.E.) Mandate**

The Parker administration's highest absolute priority is the reduction of violent crime and the enhancement of public safety across all neighborhoods. This mandate is backed by over $636 million in capital and operating funds allocated over the current Five-Year Plan. The administration is leveraging the "P.I.E." framework (Prevention, Intervention, and Enforcement) to rebuild trust between law enforcement and residents while giving first responders the tools they need to operate efficiently. Key technology dependencies to realize this goal include the final cut-over and deployment of a unified Computer Aided Dispatch (CAD) system for police and fire, the massive expansion of the Philadelphia Video Surveillance System Program (PVSSP) featuring 360-degree cameras, the deployment of body-worn cameras to all sworn officers, and the architectural planning for a state-of-the-art, multi-million dollar Forensics Laboratory. These initiatives demand zero-latency edge computing, hyper-resilient storage, and strict Criminal Justice Information Services (CJIS) compliance.

**Clean and Green Initiatives and Vision Zero Infrastructure**

The city has committed $853 million in new operating and capital funds toward neighborhood revitalization, expansive street paving, and aggressive beautification efforts. Interwoven with this pillar is the "Vision Zero 2030" traffic safety initiative, which was reinforced by a mayoral executive order to eliminate all traffic deaths on Philadelphia streets. The execution of Vision Zero focuses heavily on the city's High Injury Network (HIN) and requires heavy investments in geographic information systems (CityGeo), edge computing for real-time traffic monitoring, and intelligent speed assistance (ISA) integrations. This requires OIT to support distributed IoT devices, manage vast lakes of unstructured video and sensor data, and provide the compute necessary to run predictive analytics on traffic and pedestrian patterns.

**Economic Opportunity, Workforce Development, and Digital Equity**

To stimulate the local economy, the city is focusing heavily on workforce development, streamlining business operations, and fostering digital inclusion. This is highlighted by the $170 million "Jumpstart Business" program, the launch of the City College for Municipal Employment to create a pipeline for city jobs, and the modernization of the Department of Revenue's PRISM platform. Concurrently, OIT is executing a massive Digital Equity Plan. This includes outfitting 183 recreation centers with high-speed broadband, executing the "Power Up Tour" to distribute free laptops to residents, and training hundreds of digital coaches. From an enterprise IT perspective, this requires robust, scalable cloud infrastructure to support citizen-facing portals, as well as complex supply chain logistics to procure, provision, and deploy thousands of client endpoints across the municipality.

**Housing Preservation and the Homelessness (H.O.M.E.) Plan**

The administration is investing heavily in affordable housing and the eradication of street homelessness, dedicating $300 million over five years to construct and expand the Riverview Wellness Village in Northeast Philadelphia. The Mayor's Housing Opportunities Made Easy (H.O.M.E) Plan is supported by a $2 billion investment to build and preserve 30,000 housing units and create a "one-front-door" digital approach for residents applying for assistance. Furthermore, an executive order mandates the creation of 1,000 new shelter beds equipped

with wraparound medical and behavioral health services. For the technology sector, this requires the rapid deployment of pop-up network infrastructure, unified communications systems, secure mobile endpoints for field outreach workers, and interoperable data systems capable of securely handling sensitive Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act (HIPAA) regulated health information.

## 2. Power Structure & Key Stakeholders

The technological purchasing power within the City of Philadelphia is distributed between the legislative authorities who control the budget appropriations and the executive IT leaders who define the architectural standards and evaluate vendor solutions. Understanding this dual-layered power structure is absolutely critical for Dell Technologies to execute a successful, multi-threaded sales motion that appeals to both top-down financial decision-makers and bottom-up technical evaluators.

### Key Stakeholders Matrix

| Name & Title | Sphere of Influence | Recent Public Stances on Technology |
|---|---|---|
| **Cherelle L. Parker**<br>Mayor | Financial Purchaser / Executive Mandate | Advocates fiercely for a "smart, interconnected government" that utilizes technology to deliver highly efficient municipal services. She is highly supportive of using advanced data analytics and modern policing technologies to address violent crime. |
| **Kenyatta Johnson**<br>City Council President | Financial Purchaser / Legislative Authority | Drives the legislative agenda and council budget approvals. He is highly focused on grassroots community safety investments, equitable distribution of city resources, and capital budget oversight. |
| **Curtis Jones, Jr.**<br>Chair, Committee on Appropriations | Financial Purchaser / Gatekeeper | Controls the flow of capital and operating funds to city departments through legislative hearings. He serves as a critical gatekeeper for approving large, multi-year IT infrastructure funding requests. |

| Name & Title | Sphere of Influence | Recent Public Stances on Technology |
|---|---|---|
| **Rue Landau**<br>Chair, Technology & Information Services Committee | Legislative / Tech Oversight | Highly vocal on artificial intelligence transparency, ethics, and bias. Recently criticized OIT and the administration for a lack of clear AI governance documentation and strategy during contentious public city council hearings. |
| **Adam K. Thiel**<br>Managing Director / Chief Operating Officer | Executive Operations / Financial Influencer | The former Fire Commissioner now serves as the city's COO. He heavily influences public safety operations, emergency management, and the technological modernization of front-line responder equipment. |
| **Camille Duchaussee**<br>Chief Administrative Officer (CAO) | Executive Operations / Administrative Oversight | Oversees multiple internal departments including OIT, Procurement, and Human Resources. Focused on transforming service delivery, modernizing the procurement process, and resolving bureaucratic inefficiencies. |
| **Melissa Scott**<br>Chief Information Officer (CIO) | Technical Influencer / Primary Decision Maker | Appointed CIO in 2024. Background in agile application development (e.g., L&I app). Cautious but forward-looking on AI ("not early adopters, but won't be left behind"). Prioritizes digital equity, service roadmaps, and tech debt reduction. |
| **Damian Oravez**<br>Chief Information Security Officer (CISO) | Technical Gatekeeper | Appointed in 2023 from PHL Airport. Takes a strict "risk-based approach" prioritizing NIST fundamentals, cybersecurity awareness, and incident response resilience over untested emerging tech. Highly focused on enterprise defense. |

| Name & Title | Sphere of Influence | Recent Public Stances on Technology |
|---|---|---|
| **Tracy S. Borda**<br>Interim CEO / CFO, Dept. of Aviation | Financial Purchaser (Agency Level) | Assumed the Interim CEO role in early 2026 after the departure of Atif Saeed. Oversees major, federally funded airport infrastructure upgrades and operations.[5] |
| **Allen Mehta**<br>Chief Information Officer, Department of Aviation | Technical Influencer (Agency Level) | Manages a highly autonomous, heavily funded IT ecosystem at the Philadelphia International Airport (PHL). Focused on passenger experience technologies, security, and leveraging federal infrastructure grants for airport expansion. |
| **Kevin Thomas**<br>Exec. Director for Data, Analytics & Tech, Police Dept. | Technical Influencer (Agency Level) | Instrumental in translating the police department's strategic needs into actionable IT requirements. A key figure in the deployment of data analytics, CAD systems, and body-worn camera infrastructure. |
| **Kristin Bray**<br>Chief Legal Counsel / Director, Philly Stat 360 | Tech/Policy Influencer | Co-leads the city's emerging AI governance strategy alongside the CIO. Emphasizes using real-time data to drive accountability and transparency in city services, while carefully navigating the legal risks of generative AI. |

## Stakeholder Analysis & Sales Engagement Strategy

The political and technological landscape in Philadelphia requires a nuanced approach. The appointment of Melissa Scott as Chief Information Officer in 2024 represents a distinct shift toward software-defined, citizen-facing service delivery. Her previous success in leading a team of technical experts to develop and launch the Office of Licenses and Inspections' (L&I) pioneering virtual inspection mobile application highlights a strong preference for agile, highly available, and user-centric infrastructure. CIO Scott has publicly stated her intention to foster an environment of innovation, out-of-the-box thinking, and exploration of emerging technologies. However, her counterpart, Chief Information Security Officer Damian Oravez, acts as a stringent and necessary counterbalance to rapid modernization. Oravez's background leading cybersecurity at the Philadelphia International Airport instills a highly regulated, NIST-aligned approach to enterprise architecture. Oravez has publicly stated his passion for the

"defense side of the house" and his intent to focus on fundamentals and strict cyber risk management. Any Dell solution proposed to the city—particularly APEX consumption models or cloud-adjacent storage—must thoroughly pass Oravez's rigorous risk-management and compliance criteria before CIO Scott will champion the purchase.

Furthermore, the legislative oversight provided by City Council presents an additional layer of complexity. Councilmember Rue Landau's recent scrutiny of the city's AI readiness indicates a highly politicized environment surrounding emerging tech. During recent hearings, Landau and other councilmembers expressed grave concerns about AI bias, privacy violations, and the lack of a comprehensive citywide AI strategy, stating that city tech officials "failed their first AI test". This indicates that any AI-driven infrastructure proposals must be accompanied by stringent data governance, privacy preservation, and bias-mitigation frameworks. Dell Technologies must arm the Account Executive with clear, defensible messaging on how Dell AI Factory solutions and local Large Language Model (LLM) deployments ensure strict data sovereignty. By demonstrating how Dell infrastructure keeps sensitive municipal data completely on-premises and out of public cloud models, the sales team can directly address City Council's fears of data leakage and algorithmic bias, positioning Dell as a safe, ethical partner for the city's AI ambitions.

# 3. IT Governance & Service Delivery Model

## Operating Model: Federated with Centralized Gatekeeping

The City of Philadelphia operates under a **partially decentralized, or federated, IT service delivery model**. While the Office of Innovation and Technology (OIT) serves as the central nervous system for the municipality—managing the core network backbone, enterprise cybersecurity protocols, primary data center operations, and citywide enterprise applications (such as Microsoft 365, geographic information systems, and unified communications)—several large, high-spend agencies maintain their own discrete IT leadership, budgets, and operational autonomy.

Departments such as the Philadelphia Police Department (PPD), the Philadelphia Fire Department (PFD), the Department of Aviation (PHL Airport), and the Water Department execute their own strategic IT deployments tailored to their unique mission-critical requirements. To manage the inherent complexities of this federated environment, OIT has spent the last strategic cycle attempting to rein in "shadow IT" and redundant spending by enforcing strict enterprise architectural standards, unified product lifecycle management, and a centralized service catalog. OIT essentially acts as a governance overlay and a technological gatekeeper. For example, while a department like the Police Department may own the specific budget and operational mandate for a new digital forensics tool or mobile reporting application, OIT must validate the infrastructure's security posture, its integration capabilities via the city's new Integration Platform as a Service (iPaaS), and its overall network compatibility before procurement can proceed.

## Operational Friction Points & Chargeback Limitations

The city's IT delivery model is currently bottlenecked by several systemic organizational and operational friction points. These pain points are openly acknowledged in strategic documentation and present immediate opportunities for Dell to position managed services, utility billing models, and streamlined procurement solutions:

1. **Lack of a Unified, Automated Chargeback Model:** A critical vulnerability in the city's IT governance is the apparent lack of a mature, automated chargeback or cost-allocation model for IT resource consumption across departments. Because individual departments are not universally or accurately billed for their exact, real-time consumption of compute cycles, storage arrays, or data center floor space, there is little to no financial incentive for individual agencies to optimize their hardware footprints. This structural flaw inherently leads to unstructured data sprawl, localized server hoarding, and vast inefficiencies in hardware utilization, as departments over-provision to protect their respective budgets. Data is unavailable regarding the exact historical inter-departmental chargeback invoices, underscoring the opacity of the current cost-allocation methodology.
2. **Transactional Hiring and Severe Staffing Shortages:** OIT is suffering from severe bureaucratic friction within its human resources and hiring processes. The OIT Strategic Plan explicitly notes that current HR processes are overly transactional, focusing heavily on basic budgeting and onboarding rather than proactive talent acquisition. This bureaucratic inefficiency results in a pronounced inability to rapidly recruit and retain specialized technical talent in high-demand, highly competitive fields such as network engineering, cloud architecture, and cybersecurity. The lack of tier-3 engineering talent forces OIT to rely heavily on automated tools or external managed service providers.
3. **Procurement and RFP Inefficiencies:** The traditional Request for Proposal (RFP) process is cited internally as a major operational hurdle. Vendors frequently struggle to decipher the city's stringent terms and conditions, complex data privacy requirements, and rigid digital design standards. This friction leads to delayed project kick-offs, misaligned vendor deliverables, and an over-reliance on pre-vetted cooperative purchasing agreements to bypass the local RFP process.
4. **Decentralized Asset Management:** Because physical hardware is distributed across semi-autonomous departments and remote facilities, tracking the lifecycle, warranty status, and security posture of physical assets is a known vulnerability. OIT struggles to maintain a unified configuration management database (CMDB), complicating hardware refresh cycles and incident response efforts.

**Dell Strategic Implication:** The combination of an opaque chargeback model, decentralized hardware, and severe engineering staffing shortages creates a perfect storm for **Dell APEX**. By offering infrastructure-as-a-service, Dell can abstract the complexities of hardware management and provide predictable, flat-rate, consumption-based OpEx billing. This completely bypasses the need for the city's finance department to manually calculate inter-departmental hardware depreciation and cost allocation. Furthermore, positioning Dell

Managed Services and ProDeploy can directly alleviate the pressure caused by OIT's inability to hire infrastructure engineers, allowing the city to outsource the heavy lifting of deployment and lifecycle management.

# 4. Financials & Budget Breakdown

Philadelphia's municipal fiscal year runs from **July 1 to June 30**. The final quarter of the fiscal year (April through June) represents a highly critical buying window for technology vendors, as city departments scramble to encumber unspent operating funds before they lapse and revert to the general fund balance at year-end.

## Total & IT Budget Analysis

The Parker administration's proposed budget for Fiscal Year 2027 is a historic **$7 billion operating budget**.[1] This represents a new high-water mark for recent municipal spending, driven by strong local revenue and the administration's aggressive Five-Year Plan, which proposes $641.7 million in new operating investments through FY31.[2]

Within this macro budgetary framework, the **Office of Innovation and Technology (OIT)** manages significant capital across its various divisions (with a baseline FY26 General Fund budget exceeding $160 million). This budgetary expansion is driven heavily by the need to meet expanding cybersecurity mandates, execute massive public safety technology implementations, and offset the rising costs of enterprise software licensing.

The OIT budget is distinctly categorized into recurring operational spend (O&M) and net-new capital/equipment investments, providing clear visibility into where technology dollars flow:

- **Class 100 (Employee Compensation / O&M):** Covers the payroll, health benefits, and pension obligations for hundreds of budgeted full-time IT positions within the department.
- **Class 200 (Purchase of Services / O&M):** This is by far the largest segment of the OIT budget. It funds ongoing enterprise IT operations, external vendor contracts, major software licensing agreements (such as Microsoft Enterprise Agreements, Salesforce, and Nuance), cloud consumption costs, and managed cybersecurity services.
- **Class 300/400 (Materials, Supplies & Equipment / Capital):** This category is specifically targeted at physical hardware procurement. This pool of capital is dedicated to purchasing telecommunications equipment, executing massive PC refresh programs, acquiring mobile data computers for first responders, and upgrading core server and storage infrastructure.

## Grants, External Funding, and Subsidies

While the General Fund provides the baseline for IT operations, the city supplements its local tax revenue with substantial federal and state grant injections. These external funds are highly applicable to technology modernization and often bypass standard local budget constraints:

- **PEMA 911 Formula Funding:** The Pennsylvania Emergency Management Agency (PEMA) provides the city with over **$30 million annually** via a strict formula-based grant. These funds are rigidly siloed and must be used *solely* for E-911 technology, computer-aided dispatch (CAD) hardware, 800MHz radio infrastructure, and telecommunications supporting the Police and Fire departments.
- **Federal Infrastructure Bills (IIJA):** The Department of Aviation, which operates the Philadelphia International Airport (PHL) and Northeast Philadelphia Airport (PNE), is a major beneficiary of federal grants. Recently, the aviation division received over **$30 million** in Infrastructure Investment and Jobs Act (IIJA) funding. These federal dollars free up local airport capital to be redirected toward terminal IT enhancements, security camera upgrades, and unified communications infrastructure. Furthermore, OIT is actively pursuing federal Bipartisan Infrastructure Law grants to fund the completion of its citywide Digital Equity Plan.
- **State Public Safety Grants (PCCD):** The Police Department successfully secured a **$25 million** Local Law Enforcement Grant from the Pennsylvania Commission on Crime and Delinquency (PCCD). This massive influx of state capital is designated to expand investigative capabilities and purchase high-end scientific and technological equipment for the new Forensics Laboratory.
- **ARPA Expiration Impact:** It is critical to note that the city's $1.4 billion allocation of federal American Rescue Plan Act (ARPA) funds has been fully exhausted and allocated as of the December 2024 U.S. Treasury deadline. The removal of this flexible funding source places immense pressure on the city's General Fund, requiring OIT to demonstrate strict ROI and cost-savings for any new infrastructure requests.

# 5. Strategic Initiatives & Projects (Focus on Top 3)

The following three capitalized initiatives represent the highest-value, most technologically complex modernization efforts currently funded by the City of Philadelphia. These projects command significant capital outlays and require enterprise-grade hardware solutions.

## 1. Unified Computer-Aided Dispatch (CAD), 800MHz Radio Overhaul, & Drone Operations

- **The Executive Mandate:** Driven by Mayor Parker's "Safer City" initiative and the administration's core mandate to reduce emergency response times, improve inter-agency communication, and streamline the dispatch of first responders during critical incidents.
- **The Owning Agency:** Jointly owned by the Philadelphia Police Department (PPD), the Philadelphia Fire Department (PFD), and the OIT Emergency 911 Administration division.
- **Project Details & IT Requirements:** The city is executing a complex cut-over to a modern, unified CAD system that completely integrates Police and Fire dispatch into a single, interoperable platform. Concurrently, OIT finalized a massive **$27 million contract amendment** to upgrade the public safety 800MHz radio system to a fiber broadband

backhaul. Furthermore, Police Commissioner Kevin Bethel recently emphasized the deployment of new drone programs and a 911 texting service, expanding the scope of public safety technology.[6]

- **The Underlying Infrastructure Need: High-Availability Edge Compute & Mission-Critical Storage.** NG911 and unified CAD applications are highly sensitive to latency and require absolute zero-downtime environments. The city requires robust edge computing clusters located directly at dispatch centers, supported by localized, highly redundant, all-flash storage arrays. Drones generate massive amounts of unstructured video and telemetry data that will directly compound the immediate need for high-density, CJIS-compliant storage.[6] This necessitates enterprise-grade hyperconverged infrastructure (HCI) deployments at the network edge.

## 2. Office of Forensic Science (OFS) Laboratory Construction & Modernization

- **The Executive Mandate:** Driven by the P.I.E. (Prevention, Intervention, Enforcement) framework, this project aims to drastically improve the city's homicide clearance rates and leverage advanced, science-based evidence processing to reduce violent crime.
- **The Owning Agency:** The Philadelphia Police Department (PPD).
- **Project Details & IT Requirements:** The city has allocated a staggering **$67 million over the Five-Year Plan** to construct, outfit, and operate a new, state-of-the-art Forensics Laboratory located at the 3.0 University Place building in West Philadelphia. This facility will serve as the central hub for the city's DNA analysis, digital device forensics, ballistic imaging, and advanced toxicology.
- **The Underlying Infrastructure Need: Massive Unstructured Data Storage & High-Performance Compute (HPC).** Modern digital forensics (extracting data from encrypted smartphones) and genomic sequencing generate petabytes of complex, unstructured data. The PPD will immediately require high-density, easily scalable Network Attached Storage (NAS) solutions. Furthermore, they will need heavy-duty compute clusters capable of rapid forensic data processing and rendering. Crucially, the storage architecture must feature immutable, air-gapped backup capabilities to ensure strict chain-of-custody compliance and absolute protection against ransomware for all digital evidence.

## 3. Vision Zero 2030, Smart Transportation, and PVSSP Expansion

- **The Executive Mandate:** Driven by the "Clean and Green" pillar and a specific mayoral executive order committing the city to eliminate all traffic-related deaths and serious injuries by 2030.
- **The Owning Agency:** The Office of Transportation and Infrastructure Systems (OTIS), the Department of Streets, and the Police Department.
- **Project Details & IT Requirements:** The Vision Zero 2030 Action Plan focuses heavily on deploying technology along the city's "High Injury Network"—the 12% of Philadelphia

streets that account for 80% of all traffic deaths. To enforce this, the city is piloting Intelligent Speed Assistance (ISA), deploying automated speed enforcement cameras, and expanding the Philadelphia Video Surveillance System Program (PVSSP) with hundreds of new 360-degree cameras in "Safe Play Zones". The city is also integrating health and crash datasets to better understand injury patterns.
- **The Underlying Infrastructure Need: IoT Edge Inferencing, Video Management Systems (VMS), and Data Lake Consolidation.** Expanding automated enforcement and the PVSSP requires vast amounts of storage optimized for high-definition video ingest. The city requires ruggedized edge gateways placed at intersections to process video feeds locally (reducing bandwidth strain), alongside massive, centralized object storage data lakes to house the resulting telemetry and video data for long-term legal retention.

# 6. Procurement, Vendor Landscape, & Compliance

## Procurement Vehicles & Preferred Purchasing Methods

Philadelphia's procurement apparatus is highly bureaucratic, heavily regulated, and favors the use of established cooperative contract vehicles to bypass lengthy, politically fraught public bidding requirements for standard IT goods.

- **Primary Contract Vehicles:** The city heavily utilizes the **National Association of State Procurement Officials (NASPO) ValuePoint** cooperative purchasing agreements. Specifically, OIT relies on the Software Value Added Reseller (SVAR) contracts, notably contract numbers **CTR060025 and CTR060028**, to rapidly procure enterprise software and subscriptions.[78] Furthermore, the city actively participates in **OMNIA Partners**, **Sourcewell**, and **GSA Schedules** to procure hardware and telecommunications equipment.
- **Local Preference Mandates:** The city strictly enforces Section 17-109 of the Philadelphia Code, which grants a **5% to 10% bid preference discount** to certified Local Business Entities (LBEs). To maintain a competitive pricing edge in open bids, Dell must actively partner with certified Philadelphia-based LBEs or Minority/Women/Disabled-Owned Business Enterprises (M/W/DSBE) to fulfill hardware contracts.
- **The Purchasing Rhythm:** High-dollar services, supplies, and equipment (SS&E) bids are strictly managed by the central Procurement Department, acting as the contracting authority, though the technical and architectural specifications are entirely dictated by OIT.

## The Battlefield: Vendor Landscape & Incumbents

The infrastructure and software landscape within the city is highly contested by tier-one enterprise vendors, with significant legacy footprints that are ripe for displacement:

- **Compute & Storage: HPE** and **Dell** maintain massive, deeply entrenched footprints across the city's primary data centers and agency-level server rooms. For example, recent micro-purchases originating from the Department of Aviation (PHL) explicitly

requested maintenance and support renewals for large, mixed deployments of both Dell and HP servers. HPE's aggressive SLED strategy is bolstered by their recent $931 million DoD hybrid cloud contract, signaling their intent to push GreenLake consumption models into high-sector environments. Competitors like **Cisco** are deeply embedded in the networking, VoIP, and security stack, evidenced by recent massive renewals for Cisco Secure Access Subscriptions. **NetApp** maintains a presence in specific high-storage environments.

- **Endpoints:** The city utilizes a highly mixed client environment. While traditional Windows/PC hardware (Dell/Lenovo/HP) dominates the general enterprise and ruggedized public safety spaces, specific agencies utilize premium Apple products.
- **Security & Cloud:** The city has standardized on **CrowdStrike** for endpoint detection and response (EDR), recently deploying it to the Free Library system to align peripheral agencies with citywide OIT security standards. Cloud migrations are active but highly cautious, with OIT favoring hybrid architectures over total public cloud reliance due to cost unpredictability and security concerns.

### Compliance & Regulatory Drivers

Any technology hardware or software sold into the City of Philadelphia must map to incredibly strict, overlapping regulatory frameworks:

- **NIST & Cyber Resilience:** CISO Damian Oravez strictly enforces the National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST) cybersecurity framework across all municipal deployments.
- **StateRAMP / GovRAMP:** Cloud vendors and managed service providers must adhere to StateRAMP (currently transitioning to the GovRAMP branding) standards to ensure baseline data protection and continuous monitoring for any cloud-hosted municipal applications.
- **CJIS Compliance:** The Unified CAD, PVSSP camera networks, and the new Forensics Lab projects require absolute, strict adherence to Criminal Justice Information Services (CJIS) data handling, encryption, and physical security protocols.
- **AI Governance Mandates:** In response to the rapid proliferation of Generative AI, CIO Melissa Scott established a foundational 2023 AI guideline document focused heavily on ethics, transparency, and accountability. However, an advisory committee is currently formulating much stricter governance policies. During recent public hearings, city leaders were pressured to ensure that municipal data is never exposed to public LLM training models. Furthermore, in December 2025, federal **Executive Order 14365** was issued to preempt and restrict state and local AI regulations to create a unified national framework, introducing complex regulatory uncertainty at the local level.[910] Solutions utilizing AI must prove absolute data sovereignty and navigate this evolving legal landscape.

## 7. Actionable Dell Opportunities

Based on the strategic mandates, massive financial capitalization, and distinct operational

friction points within the City of Philadelphia, the following represent high-probability, actionable sales motions for Dell Technologies.

**Funded Alignment: The Enterprise & Public Safety Device Refresh**

OIT continues to budget heavy capital funds to replace aging endpoints across the enterprise and public safety divisions. Dell must aggressively position its **Client Solutions Group (CSG)** portfolio—ranging from standard Latitude laptops for administrative staff to Latitude Rugged models for Streets Department field workers and Police mobile data computers. To win this massive procurement, Dell should lead heavily with **Dell ProDeploy and TechDirect**. Because OIT actively suffers from transactional hiring and severe tier-1 support staff shortages, offering zero-touch provisioning—where devices arrive pre-imaged, enrolled in endpoint management, and ready for the end-user—will directly solve CIO Melissa Scott's operational bottlenecks.

**Funded Alignment: Office of Forensic Science Storage Architecture & Police Drones** With a historic $67 million allocated to construct and equip the new West Philadelphia Forensics Lab, the Police Department immediately requires infrastructure capable of handling petabytes of highly sensitive evidentiary data. This is now further compounded by the Police Department's new drone surveillance program.[6] Dell should position **PowerScale (Isilon)** to fulfill the need for high-density, easily scalable unstructured data storage, paired with **PowerEdge compute nodes** optimized for heavy workloads (DNA rendering and drone video ingest). The Account Executive must emphasize the CJIS-compliant immutability, cyber-vaulting, and absolute chain-of-custody protections inherent in Dell's storage software and **PowerProtect** portfolio to satisfy the CISO's stringent ransomware defense requirements.

**Whitespace & Advisory: Localized AI-Ready Infrastructure & Governance** City Council (led by Tech Chair Rue Landau) is highly skeptical of AI transparency, and the CIO/CISO are currently drafting strict AI data governance rules to prevent sensitive municipal data from leaking into public Large Language Models. With the recent macro-political disruption of federal Executive Order 14365 (which preempts local AI laws and restricts BEAD funding)[10][11] Dell must help the city navigate regulatory uncertainty by providing highly controlled, trusted infrastructure. Dell can establish a lucrative advisory position by introducing the **Dell AI Factory with NVIDIA**. By pitching *on-premises, private AI infrastructure*, Dell can help the city harness the power of AI for operational efficiency without violating the CISO's strict NIST and data sovereignty requirements, completely bypassing the political and regulatory nightmare of utilizing public cloud AI services.

**Competitive Displacement: APEX to Circumvent Chargeback Friction & CapEx Limitations**

The City of Philadelphia critically lacks a unified chargeback model, making it incredibly difficult for OIT to accurately bill federated departments for their consumption of central data center resources. Furthermore, managing disparate, aging hardware lifecycles across dozens of departments is a known security vulnerability. Dell should aggressively pitch **Dell APEX** (Data Center Utility or Compute/Storage as-a-Service) to displace aging HPE server footprints. APEX provides a predictable, OpEx-driven consumption model that allows the city's Budget Office to easily forecast costs and bill departments based on precise usage, completely eliminating the

need for a complex internal hardware depreciation metric. It allows the city to maintain the security and control of on-premise infrastructure while gaining the financial agility and elasticity of the public cloud.

**Competitive Displacement: Edge Security and Vision Zero Video Expansion**

The city is actively expanding its Philadelphia Video Surveillance System Program (PVSSP) by deploying hundreds of new 360-degree cameras to combat violent crime, while simultaneously scaling intersection cameras for the Vision Zero 2030 traffic safety initiative. High-definition video data is notoriously difficult to manage at the edge and prohibitively expensive to backhaul and store in the public cloud. Dell should target this expansion by positioning **Dell native Edge Solutions (e.g., VxRail or PowerEdge XR series)** at the network edge for localized video processing and inferencing, paired with scalable central storage for secure, long-term legal retention. This displaces fragmented, legacy DVR/NVR storage systems and provides the Police and Streets departments with an end-to-end, highly resilient video management architecture that guarantees the 95%+ uptime mandated by OIT's performance metrics.

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